Blooming Prosperity

How Horticulture is Changing Farmers' Lives in UP



Yogi Adityanath, Hon'ble Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh, has prioritized farmers and agriculture for the state's progress. His vision focuses on boosting farmers' income and enhancing their standard of living. The Horticulture and Food Processing Department plays a pivotal role in achieving this. With its support, farmers are diversifying beyond traditional paddy-wheat farming into horticulture and allied businesses, significantly increasing their earnings. UP farmers now market their products across the nation and even internationally. Through government schemes and departmental assistance, farmers are becoming self-reliant, contributing to the state economy's growth while achieving improved financial stability and prosperity.

Growing Wealth: Farmers Thrive with Horticulture Innovations

Growing demand for fruits and vegetables in Uttar Pradesh has made horticulture crops prominent. Districts like Kushinagar, Lakhimpur Kheri, Barabanki, and Sitapur are emerging as major hubs for banana cultivation. In Bundelkhand and other regions, farmers are adopting climate-appropriate crops such as strawberries, dragon fruit, and dates. Additionally, honey production and hi-tech farming techniques are playing a crucial role in boosting farmers' income. These efforts are transforming agriculture in the state and helping farmers achieve higher profitability through diversification.



The Honey Revolution: Eastern Farmers Flourish

Raju Singh, a resident of Harpur village in Gorakhpur, manages 1,000 bee boxes, producing 250-300 quintals of honey annually. In 2022, he founded his firm, High Growth Agro Enterprises, and set up a honey processing plant with the help of the Horticulture Department. He now sells processed and packed honey directly to customers online, generating an annual turnover of about ₹1 crore. According to Raju Singh, many farmers in Eastern UP are benefiting from beekeeping with the department's support, improving their livelihoods significantly.



Rising Income with Dragon Fruit: A Sweet Harvest for UP Farmers

Farmers in Mirzapur and Sonbhadra districts are reaping significant benefits from dragon fruit cultivation, increasing their income fivefold. In 2018-19, farmer Ramji Dubey planted dragon fruit on 2.5 acres with departmental support, earning ₹4-5 lakh per acre. Similarly, Saris Singh, a woman farmer from Bagoda village, started cultivating dragon fruit on 1.25 acres in 2022 and now earns ₹6 lakh annually. Priced at ₹300 per kilogram, dragon fruit yields 40 quintals per acre, with farmers receiving a ₹30,000 grant from the Horticulture Department. Currently, 250-300 farmers in these districts are transforming their livelihoods through this initiative.

Polyhouses: Turning Small Farmers into Millionaires

In Bagalipur village, Varanasi, young farmer Avneesh Kumar Patel set up a polyhouse on 1,008 square meters in 2021, costing ₹9.5 lakh with a 50% subsidy from the Horticulture Department. Growing spinach, capsicum, and tomatoes, Avneesh earns an impressive ₹5-6 lakh net income annually. His success demonstrates how small farmers can achieve higher incomes and even become millionaires with government support. This impactful initiative highlights the transformative potential of departmental assistance in empowering farmers to adopt modern agricultural practices and secure a prosperous future.

Unmatched Earnings Through Drip Irrigation in Bundelkhand

Drip irrigation has transformed farming in Bundelkhand, boosting farmers' incomes. Ramji Kushwaha from Khetwas village, Lalitpur, installed a drip irrigation system on 2.5 acres with departmental support, cultivating flowers and tomatoes to earn ₹3.5 lakh in six months. In Jhansi's Patharkarka village, Pushpendra Singh Yadav grows medicinal crops like tulsi on 10 acres, earning ₹60,000 per acre in just 2.5 months. Pushpendra also founded the Bundelkhand Medicinal Farmer Producer Company, uniting 1,072 farmers to cultivate tulsi across 40,132 acres. A tulsi oil extraction and drying unit worth ₹29 lakh was established with a 33% subsidy from the department. These initiatives showcase impactful strides in sustainable agriculture, empowering farmers and enhancing livelihoods.

" Holistic Growth Through Horticulture Department's Multi-Approach Strategy "

Dr. V.B. Dwivedi, Director of Horticulture, Uttar Pradesh, highlights the department's impactful initiatives promoting horticulture and related businesses. To boost vegetable production and quality, technologies like polyhouses, shade nets, and drip/sprinkler irrigation systems are being encouraged. Schemes for rejuvenating old orchards, mushroom cultivation, honey production, and food processing are also gaining momentum. These efforts have significantly enhanced farmers' interest in horticulture, resulting in a steady increase in their income and contributing to the sector's growth. The department's work is transforming agriculture into a more sustainable and profitable venture.

